Chia-Le Yen (顏嘉樂)

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Education

Master of Social Work (MSW) — August 2026 – Present
Washington University in St. Louis — St. Louis, MO

Master of Arts in Economics — September 2024 – July 2026
National Taiwan University — Taipei, Taiwan

Bachelor of Arts, Double Major in Social Work and Economics — September 2019 – June 2024
National Taiwan University — Taipei, Taiwan

Honors & Awards

Best Master's Thesis Award in Policy Research — November 2026
Taiwan Economic Association & Taiwan Association for Public Issues Research

Honorable Mention, Best Master's Thesis Award (Public Economics) — November 2026
Taiwan Economic Association

Brown School Global Social Work Scholars Award — February 2026
Brown School, Washington University in St. Louis

Publications

Wang, J. S.-H., Chen, K. M., **Yen, C. L.**, Chiang, W. H., Chiang, P. C., Wu, J., Lin, C. Y., Wu, P. H., Liang, J. C., Chang, F. L., Wang, Y. T., Shen, C. W., Cheng, C. K., & Yu, X. (In Press). The impact of putative income regulations on social assistance: A policy simulation study using a model family approach and administrative data. *Journal of Social Sciences and Philosophy* [Article in Mandarin].

Chao, S. F., Hsu, H. C., **Yen, C. L.**, & Chen, B. Y. (2025). Examining the longitudinal influence of loneliness on healthcare utilization: Evidence from Taiwan's National Health Insurance data. *BMC Geriatrics, 25*(1), Article 410. https://doi.org/10.1186/s12877-025-06088-0

Conference Presentations

Yen, C. L., Chen, Y. C., Yang, Y. G., & Fang, J. (2027, January, Accepted). Comparing four frailty index construction methods for mortality prediction in the Health and Retirement Study. Poster presentation at *Society for Social Work and Research 31st Annual Conference*, San Francisco, CA.

Yen, C. L., Chen, K. M., & Wang, J. S.-H. (2027, January, Accepted). Old-age social assistance and household responses: A triple-difference analysis from Taiwan. Poster presentation at *Society for Social Work and Research 31st Annual Conference*, San Francisco, CA.

Chen, Y. C., **Yen, C. L.**, Fang, J., & Yang, Y. G. (2027, January, Accepted). Frailty and mortality among older Americans: A 20-year follow-up from the Health and Retirement Study. Poster presentation at *Society for Social Work and Research 31st Annual Conference*, San Francisco, CA.

Yen, C. L., Chen, K. M., & Wang, J. S.-H. (2026, November). Old-age social assistance and household responses: A triple-difference analysis from Taiwan. Oral presentation at *Association for Public Policy Analysis and Management 48th Annual Fall Research Conference*, Boston, MA.

Research Experiences

Department of Social Work, National Taiwan University
Research Assistant

Supervisor: Yu-Chih Chen July 2025 – Present

- Restructured Health and Retirement Study waves 4–16 (1998–2022) into a documented longitudinal database, enabling reproducible cross-wave aging research.
- Compared cumulative-deficit, PCA-, and IRT-based frailty indices across 192,578 HRS person-wave observations; demonstrated strong subgroup concordance and similar mortality prediction, while PCA and IRT identified functional-dependency measures as the most informative deficits.
- Co-reviewed a manuscript for *BMC Geriatrics*, assessing its methods and analytical rigor as part of structured peer-review training.

Supervisor: Julia Shu-Huah Wang September 2022 – Present

- Integrated nationwide tax and household-registration records (2022) to estimate eligibility and take-up of low-income subsidies, supporting welfare-program evaluation and policy design.
- Analyzed and visualized policy differences across major European and Asian cities by urbanicity, family structure, and life-course stage to evaluate social-safety-net equity.

Supervisor: Shiau-Fang Chao March 2022 – December 2024

- Coauthored a study linking National Health Insurance (2015) and Taiwan Longitudinal Study on Aging (2015–2018) data to assess how loneliness shapes healthcare use among older adults.
- Linked mental-health survey responses from hundreds of older adults with geospatial and environmental measures to examine how living environments relate to psychological well-being.

Department of Economics, National Taiwan University
Research Assistant at C2L2 Lab

Supervisor: Kuan-Ming Chen September 2022 – Present

- Cleaned, integrated, and modeled large-scale administrative data for the government partnership "Issue-Oriented Big Data Analyses on Social Inclusion and Smart Governance"; constructed multidimensional-disadvantage indicators to identify long-term-care supply–demand gaps.
- Coauthored a study linking administrative records and applying a triple-difference design to estimate the effects of low-income subsidies on older adults' living arrangements and the responses of their spouses and children.
- Analyzed Taiwan's Survey of Family Income and Expenditure (1976–2022), decomposing long-run changes in labor-force participation and benchmarking them against OECD trends.

Teaching Experiences

Teaching Assistant

Social Statistics (BSW Level) February 2026 – June 2026
Instructor: **Yu-Chih Chen**

- Led 9 hours of instruction through lectures and labs in R and SPSS, covering descriptive statistics, data visualization, and inferential methods such as t-tests, ANOVA, correlation, and regression, while providing statistical guidance to students.

Freshman Seminar (Undergraduate Level) September 2021 – January 2022
Instructor: **April Chiung-Tao Shen**

- Mentored first-year students in adjusting to university life, provided advising on academic and personal concerns, and introduced campus resources.

Guest Speaker

Advanced Social Statistics (MSW Level) May 2026
Instructor: **Yu-Chih Chen**

- Presented 2 guest lectures (6 hours total) on binary, ordinal, and multinomial logistic regression, integrating significance testing with hands-on Stata demonstrations.

Big Data Analysis in Social Welfare (MSW Level) September 2025 – December 2025
Instructor: **Yu-Chih Chen**

- Gave 2 guest lectures on Taiwan's open data platforms and introductory regression in R; provided individual guidance on technical and statistical questions.

Social Work Research Methods (BSW Level) April 2025, November 2023
Instructor: **Julia Shu-Huah Wang**

- Facilitated an R workshop using randomized controlled trial data to teach data cleaning, visualization, statistical analysis, and interpretation.

Practicum Experiences

Department of Social Welfare, Taipei City Government July 2023 – September 2023
Social Work Intern (Full-Time, 240 Hours) Taipei, Taiwan

- Assessed an aging rural community's needs and resources to identify mobility barriers and recommend public transportation improvements.
- Developed a dementia-prevention program in which older residents co-created a "Community Life Map," using stories and memories to encourage cognitive engagement and social connection.
- Designed a local produce market initiative and coordinated surplus-exchange plans with community managers to support resource sharing across neighboring communities.

Pley School Organization September 2022 – January 2023
Social Work Intern (Part-Time, 200 Hours) Taipei, Taiwan

- Collaborated with the Taiwan Fund for Children and Families to design weekend activities using stories and games, helping children from low-income fishing families explore their community and parents' occupations.
- Wrote weekly articles and developed discussion topics based on the UN Sustainable Development Goals, providing free, child-friendly reading materials on international issues.

Skills & Languages

Programming Skills	Python, R, Julia, MATLAB, Stata, SPSS, LaTeX
Research Methods	Causal inference, machine learning, spatial analysis, text analysis, etc.
Languages	Mandarin (native); English (TOEFL iBT: 103)